

Falling in love with the problem

2026

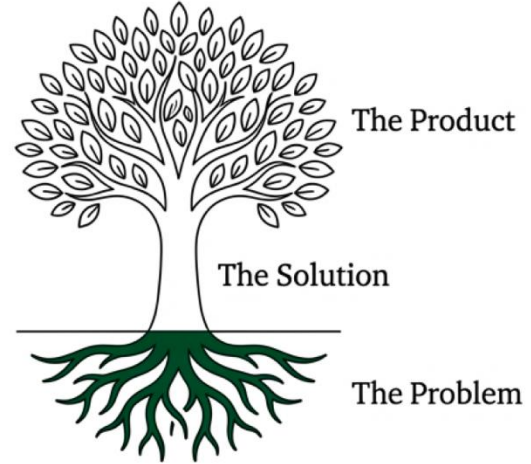


“

*Fall in love with
the problem, not
the solution.*

Uri Levine, Founder of Waze

Most startups fail not because the technology implies a lack of capability, but because they solve a problem that serves no market need.



If the root is weak, the tree falls.



Part 1 : The Problem



Phrasing the Problem: From Observation to Definition

The Vague Observation	People need healthy food.
The End-User Perspective	I am a busy professional... I don't have time to grocery shop... This makes me feel upset.
The 4Ws + 1 Perspective (Strong) who, what, where and why. + when	Our busy working professional is struggling to eat healthy food during the week as she is consistently working long hours. Our solution needs to deliver a quick and convenient way to purchase healthy food.

A robust problem statement includes the Who, the Context, and the Emotional/Functional Deficit.



The Anatomy of a Problem: The 5Ws Framework

WHO

Who are the stakeholders affected?

WHAT

What is the current state vs. desired state? (The Unmet Need)

WHEN

Timeframe and frequency of the issue.

WHERE

Location, department, or region.

WHY

The Critical Gap. Why is it worth solving? What is the magnitude of the problem?



Activity: The 99 Problems Challenge

1. Navigate to OpinionX (opinionx.co/99-problems).
2. Select one startup from the list.
3. Task: Rephrase that startup's problem statement using the 5W Framework.
4. Bonus: Identify one other vertical/industry that might face a similar problem.

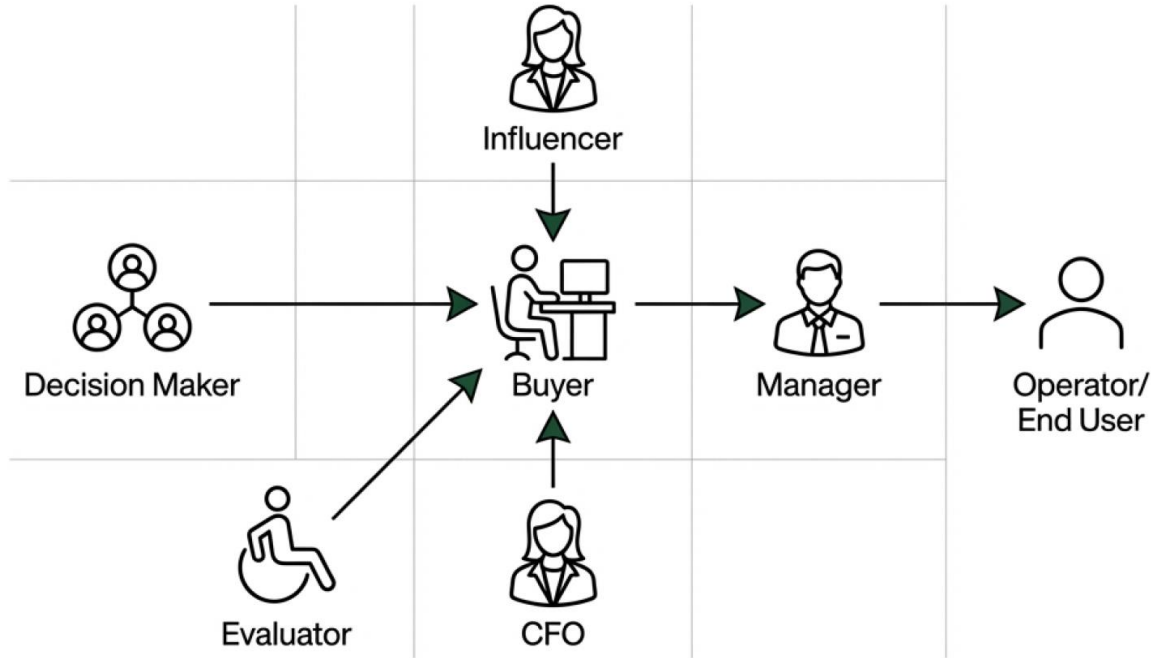


Upload your answers on moodle

opinionx.co/99-problems



Beyond the End User: Mapping the Stakeholder Ecosystem



Example: Salesforce.

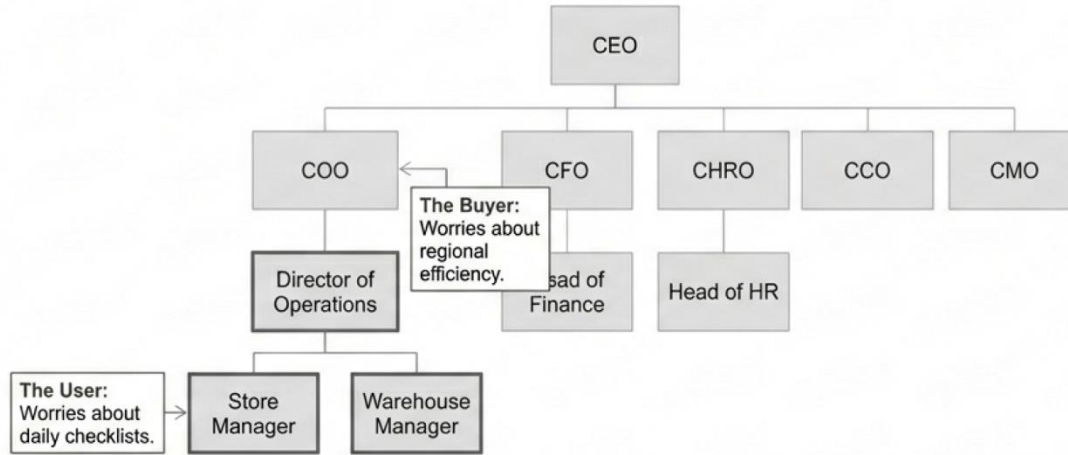
The Rep is the User.

The VP of Sales is
the Buyer.

The CFO is the
Decision Maker.



Organizational Complexity: Who Holds the Keys?



1. Based on the Madura Fashion case study, formulate a problem statement.
2. Who is the Buyer for a new retail operations software?
3. Who is the End User?
4. Sprint Task: Formulate one survey question for the client (instructor) to validate this problem.

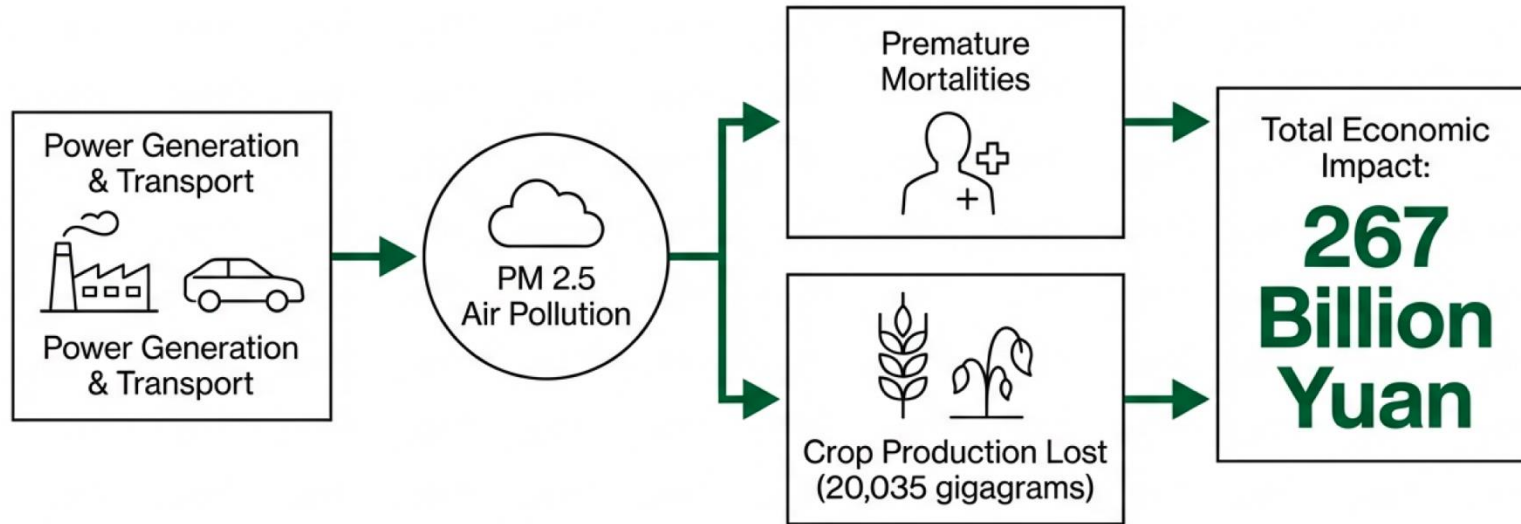


Part 2 : The Implications



How Big Is this Problem?

What happens If You Don't solve



How Often Is This Problem Being Faced?



Get

Daily Store Opening Checklist

Ensure That Your Store Is Ready To Receive Customers on Time, Each Morning Anyone that has ever been put in charge of store opening protocols is acute...



Get

Daily Store Closing Checklist

Be Assured of a Safe and Timely Store-Closing, Every Day We know how critical store closing protocols are to you and your business. Ensuring that all ...



Get

Visual Merchandising Audit

Implement VM changes easier and faster while driving consistent look and feel across businesses. A monthly or quarterly merchandising audit is a great...



Get

Customer Feedback

Deliver The Most Efficient Customer Experience Possible Retaining customers and building loyalty is one of the key factors that contribute towards the...



Get

Mystery Shopper Audit

Conduct Undercover Audits to gauge Business Readiness Ensuring compliance on an everyday basis can get tricky and very expensive to the business if st...



Get

Store Operations Audit

Build Accountability Between In-store Teams Every element present in a store is a vital component to contribute towards optimising and ensuring succes...



Get

Store Visit Report

Get the Most Out of Store Visit Reports Area Managers often visit stores and conduct audits on spreadsheets which usually tend to provide little to ...



Get

Temperature Log

Ensure a safe and secure environment for your procurements. Temperature log documentation is a vital tool in the food processing industry as it is str...



Get

Restaurant Operations Audit

Build Accountability Between Teams Every element present in a restaurant is a vital component to contribute towards optimising and ensuring success ...



How Many Are Facing This Problem?

MAGNITUDE

1 Million

Helvetica Now Display

People who will have a heart attack or die from coronary heart disease this year.

FREQUENCY

103 Million

Adults with high blood pressure.

TREND

38%

Helvetica Now Display

Rise in number of high blood pressure deaths

High Frequency + High Magnitude = Urgent Problem (Painkiller)

Source: American Heart Association, 2018 Heart Disease and Stroke Statistics Update



The Art of Customer Discovery: Survey Design

Guidelines

- Avoid leading questions (e.g., “Do you like our idea?”).
- Focus on past behavior (e.g., “When was the last time you...?”).
- Quantify the pain (e.g., “How much time did you lose?”).

References

StudioZao: What Customer
Discovery Questions to Ask

SurveyMonkey: Survey Guidelines

Reading material on a good survey

<https://studiozao.com/resources/what-customer-discovery-questions-to-ask-to-validate-pain-points>.

<https://www.surveymonkey.com/mp/survey-guidelines/>

Bias is the enemy of validation.



Class Drill: The Bias Trap

~~Bad: Would you pay for software that helps store managers?
(Hypothetical)~~



Good: How many hours a week do your store managers currently spend on manual reporting?
(Factual/Quantifiable)

Activity: Critique your team's survey question.



Assignment: Validate Your Problem

☒	Design a Survey. Based on the guidelines discussed (Slides 12 & 13).
☒	Define Target Audience. Who is your 'Who' from the 5Ws?
☒	Execute. Collect at least 20 responses.
☒	Synthesize. Summarize results and update your Pitch Deck.



Your opinion doesn't matter. **Only the customer's data** does.

